

Figure 1: KDirStat in action

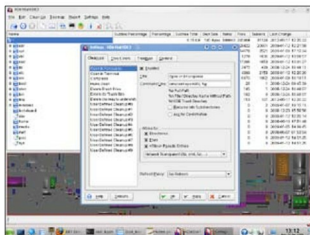


Figure 2: KDirStat settings

installed by default, you can install it using the package manager of your distribution.

After launching it, you will be asked for the directory that you want to scan for disk usage. I have scanned the entire root filesystem (/) and the output is shown in Figure 1. The output contains the directories in a sub-tree structure, usage in both graphical and numerical form, the number of files and sub-directories, and the latest modified time within an entire directory tree.

KDirStat scans the directories on your mounted filesystem and also scans the FTP or Samba directories. It provides some predefined cleanup actions like compressing it to a *tar.bz2* archive, deleting a file or a directory, or opening the directory in a terminal or in Konqueror. You can edit the cleanup actions or define your own set of actions. These settings are shown in Figure 2. If you are a systems administrator, you can even send an e-mail to the owner of the directory that's consuming a lot of space, notifying him to clean up the unused files. The option is available under the *Report* menu.

I'd recommend you play around with this software to understand its various features and functionalities.

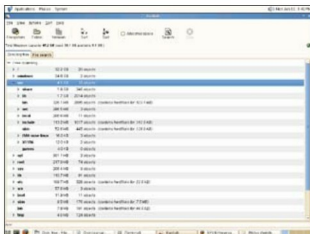


Figure 3: Filesystem disk usage scan using Baobab

Baobab from the GNOME userland

If you are a GNOME user, you've something called Baobab (a.k.a Disk Usage Analyser) to analyse the disk usage available by default. You can run it from *System→Administration→Disk Usage Analyser*.

It's similar to KDirStat. It scans the entire file system or a specific directory provided by you (local or remote). The output for the entire file system scan is shown in Figure 3. The output contains the directory tree, size and the total number of objects. It also displays the size of hard links that exist in a particular directory.

Tips to get some free space

If you install software from sources like I do, then to build it you obviously need to uncompress it and then install. After a successful installation, remove either the tar file or the uncompressed folder. Try to find out the old downloaded ISO images, etc, and delete them if they're not useful. Burn the required ISOs to CD/DVD and then also delete them.

If you're in charge of servers, I'm sure you know that a large amount of space is used for log files. Logs are very useful to track problems or debug issues. But most of the time they are unused. Check in your */var/log/* directory to find out the unused log files and compress them using gzip.

Well, that's all for now! But remember, to get good systems performance we need to keep a balance between disk usage and the free space available. Even though you have a hard disk with a high storage capacity, some day you may run out of free space. So remove the unwanted files from the disk and get more free space. **END** 

By: Sandeep Yadav

The author is a part of the LFY CD team and loves to run *./configure && make && make install* every now and then.